

The Sandbox

Bukhari Chancery Persian Textbook Development

likelihood_me-gist

PDF version of this file: likelihood_me-gist.pdf

Grammatical Explanation

Central Asian Persian has a special verbal mode to express likelihood, which it shares with Central Asian Turkic languages such as Uzbek and Uyghur. This construction is common both in spoken Tajik and in Central Asian Persian chancery documents, but less common in Central Asian Persian manuscripts.

The basic form is: the continuous particle (mē) + continuous participle (e.g., karda) + gī + ast. For instance: , "he is likely to go." In colloquial Tajik, this would be compounded as: .

Although this mode does not have a direct parallel in modern Iranian Persian, the logic closely matches several constructions in Central Asian Turkic languages. For instance, in Uzbek: u boradigan ekan, "he is likely to go."

- JP: check Uyghur manuals: there may be another way to express a similar idea

In Iranian Persian, this idea would be expressed with an additional clause (just like in English): , "it is likely that he will go".

Examples

bukh:

uzb: bir hafta orasida Chorjuy viloyatida bo'ladigan ekan

fars:

eng: He is likely to be in Chorjuy province within a week

Comments: bukh:

uzb: Agar (bir) balo bo'lsa Toshkent va Buxoro tarafidan askarlar keladigandir, albatta.

fars:

eng: If there is an uprising, then an army will surely come from Tashkent and Bukhara

Comments: bukh: ”

uzb:

fars:

eng:

References

- Persian / Tajik: Perry (245-246) calls this form ”Present-Future Conjectural,” which ”expresses a conjecture about a potential or current (habitual or iterated) action.”
- Uyghur:Tomur (360-363). What Hahn calls ”Present-Future Obligatory” (-idighan + -di + personal suffix, e.g. kelidigandimän ”I am supposed to come”) is treated by Tomur as the Past Imperfect Tense Predicate Form, formed by attaching the Past Tense of the Direct Judgment Copula (-idi) to the Imperfect Participle/Adverbial (-digan forms). This form can be used to indicate ”an intention, plan or agreement about carrying out an action prior to a certain matter” (361). (